

SHAPE

1. Passage anchor

> “Her influence has been long-lasting because it **shaped** the way I see learning, confidence, and even character.”

Passage meaning

shape = strongly influence how something develops, especially someone’s ideas, attitudes, character, or future

塑造；形成；影響……的發展

Here, Mrs. Chan did not physically give something a shape. Her influence helped **form** the speaker’s way of thinking and seeing the world.

Practice

1. Childhood experiences can **shape** the way we think as adults.

童年經歷可能會**塑造**我們成年後的思考方式。

2. Good teachers often **shape** students’ attitudes toward learning.

好老師常常會**塑造**學生對學習的態度。

Core meanings of SHAPE

2. shape — noun: the form or outline of something

= the external form, outline, or configuration of an object

形狀；外形；輪廓

Examples

1. The table has a round **shape**.

這張桌子是圓形的**形狀**。

2. Clouds constantly change **shape**.

雲朵不斷改變**形狀**。

This is the central literal noun meaning.

3. shape — a particular geometric form

= a recognizable form such as a circle, square, triangle, etc.

****圖形；形狀****

Examples

1. Children learn to recognize basic ****shapes****.

孩子們學習辨認基本****圖形****。

2. Cut the paper into different ****shapes****.

把紙剪成不同的****形狀****。

Common:

* circle

* square

* triangle

* rectangle

4. shape — outline or silhouette

= the visible outline of a person or object, especially when details are unclear

****輪廓；身影****

Examples

1. I could see a dark ****shape**** in the distance.

我可以看見遠處一個黑色的****輪廓****。

2. A human ****shape**** appeared behind the curtain.

窗簾後面出現一個人的****身影****。

This sense focuses on outline rather than exact form.

Physical form of the body

5. shape — the form of a person's body

= the overall physical form or figure of the body

****體形；身材****

Examples

1. Exercise can change your body **shape**.
運動可以改變你的**體形**。

2. The dress suits her **shape** well.
那件洋裝很適合她的**身材**。

6. in shape

= physically fit and healthy
身體狀況良好；體能好

Examples

1. I exercise regularly to stay **in shape**.
我固定運動以保持**良好體能**。

2. He got back **in shape** before the race.
他在比賽前恢復了**良好的體能狀態**。

Very common expression.

7. out of shape

= not physically fit
身材走樣；體能不佳

Examples

1. I'm really **out of shape** after months without exercise.
幾個月沒運動後，我的**體能真的變差了**。

2. He felt **out of shape** during the hike.
健行時，他感覺自己的**體能不太好**。

Depending on context, it can refer to:

- * poor fitness
- * body form

Condition or state

8. shape — condition or state

In expressions such as ****in good shape****, ****shape**** can mean general condition.

****狀況；狀態****

Examples

1. The car is still in good ****shape****.
那輛車的****狀況****仍然很好。
2. The building is in terrible ****shape****.
那棟建築的****狀況****非常差。

This can describe:

- * machines
- * buildings
- * finances
- * health
- * organizations

9. in good / bad shape

= in good or poor condition

****狀況良好 / 狀況不佳****

Examples

1. The old house is surprisingly ****in good shape****.
那棟老房子出乎意料地****保存得很好****。
2. The company's finances are ****in bad shape****.
公司的財務****狀況很差****。

Verb: give physical form

10. shape something

= give something a particular physical form

****塑形；使成形；塑造****

Examples

1. She ****shaped the clay**** into a bowl.
她把黏土****塑成碗的形狀****。
2. The craftsman ****shaped the wood**** by hand.
工匠用手把木頭****塑形****。

This is the central verb meaning.

11. shape something into something

= form something into a particular shape

****把.....塑造成.....****

Examples

1. He ****shaped the dough into a circle****.
他把麵糰****做成圓形****。
2. The metal was ****shaped into a ring****.
金屬被****塑造成一個環****。

Figurative influence and development

12. shape a person

= influence the development of someone's character, beliefs, abilities, or identity

****塑造一個人；影響某人的成長****

Examples

1. Her parents ****shaped her values****.
她的父母****塑造了她的價值觀****。
2. Travel ****shaped him**** into a more open-minded person.
旅行****塑造了他****，讓他變得更開放。

This is one of the most important figurative senses.

13. shape someone's character

= influence how a person's personality and moral qualities develop

****塑造某人的性格 / 品格****

Examples

1. Difficult experiences can ****shape character****.
艱難的經歷可以****塑造性格****。
2. Her early education ****shaped her character**** deeply.
她早期受到的教育深深****塑造了她的品格****。

Very close to the passage.

14. shape the way someone thinks / sees something

= influence someone's way of understanding or interpreting the world

****塑造某人的思考 / 看事情的方式****

Examples

1. Books can ****shape the way we see the world****.
書籍可以****塑造我們看世界的方式****。
2. That experience ****shaped how she thought about success****.
那次經歷****塑造了她對成功的看法****。

This is the exact passage pattern.

15. shape attitudes / beliefs / opinions

= strongly influence how ideas or views develop

****塑造態度 / 信念 / 看法****

Examples

1. Family can ****shape political and social attitudes****.
家庭可以****塑造政治與社會態度****。

2. Media often ****shape public opinion****.

媒體常常會****塑造輿論****。

Influence future development

16. shape the future

= influence how future events develop

****塑造未來；影響未來走向****

Examples

1. Technology will continue to ****shape the future of work****.

科技將繼續****塑造工作的未來****。

2. Today's decisions may ****shape the future**** for decades.

今天的決定可能會在未來數十年中****影響未來走向****。

17. shape an outcome

= influence the final result of a process or situation

****影響結果；塑造成果****

Examples

1. Small decisions can ****shape the final outcome****.

小決定也可能****影響最終結果****。

2. Public opinion helped ****shape the outcome**** of the debate.

公眾意見有助於****影響辯論的結果****。

18. shape policy / strategy / decisions

= influence the development or content of policy, strategy, or decisions

****塑造 / 影響政策、策略、決策****

Examples

1. Research should ****shape public policy****.

研究應該****影響公共政策的制定****。

2. Customer feedback ****shaped the company's strategy****.

顧客回饋****影響了公司的策略方向****。

Developing or emerging form

19. take shape

= begin to develop into a clear or recognizable form

****逐漸成形；初具雛形****

Examples

1. The plan is beginning to ****take shape****.

這個計畫開始****逐漸成形****。

2. A new idea slowly ****took shape**** in her mind.

一個新想法逐漸在她腦中****成形****。

Highly useful figurative expression.

20. something is taking shape

= something is becoming clearer, more organized, or more developed

****逐漸明朗；逐步成形****

Examples

1. The project is finally ****taking shape****.

這個專案終於開始****有了明確樣貌****。

2. Our travel plans are ****taking shape****.

我們的旅行計畫正****逐步成形****。

Direction or form of events

21. the shape of something to come

= an indication of how something is likely to develop in the future

****未來可能的樣貌；未來趨勢的預示****

Examples

1. This technology may show the **shape** of things to come.
這項科技可能預示**未來的發展樣貌**。
2. The new working model could be the **shape** of things to come.
這種新的工作模式可能代表**未來的趨勢**。

Idiomatic and somewhat formal.

Objects with a defined outline

22. shape — mold / form used in making something

In some practical contexts, **shape** can refer to a form or pattern used to determine outline.

模型；模具；樣板

Examples

1. Use the metal **shape** as a guide when cutting.
切割時以這個金屬**樣板**作為參考。
2. The material was pressed against a curved **shape**.
材料被壓在彎曲的**模型**上。

Lower-priority and context-dependent.

Computing / graphics

23. shape — graphic object

= a simple graphical object such as a rectangle, circle, arrow, etc.

圖形

Examples

1. Insert a **shape** into the slide.
在投影片中插入一個**圖形**。
2. You can resize the **shape** by dragging its corners.

你可以拖曳角落來調整**圖形**大小。

Very common in presentation/design software.

Mathematics and geometry

24. shape — geometric form or spatial structure

= the geometric characteristics of an object independent of its position or size

形狀；幾何形態

Examples

1. The two objects have the same **shape** but different sizes.

這兩個物體的**形狀**相同，但大小不同。

2. Geometry studies properties of **shapes**.

幾何學研究各種**圖形**的性質。

Common expressions

25. get into shape

= become physically fit

恢復體能；練好身體

Examples

1. She started running to **get into shape**.

她開始跑步來**改善體能**。

2. I want to **get into shape** before summer.

我想在夏天前把**身體練好**。

26. stay in shape

= maintain good physical fitness

保持良好體能

Examples

1. Swimming helps me ****stay in shape****.

游泳幫助我****保持體能****。

2. He walks every day to ****stay in shape****.

他每天走路以****保持良好體能****。

27. whip / get something into shape

= improve something quickly so that it becomes organized or acceptable

****整頓；迅速改善****

Examples

1. We need to ****get this project into shape**** before the meeting.

我們需要在會議前把這個專案****整理完善****。

2. The new manager quickly ****whipped the team into shape****.

新經理很快就把團隊****整頓得有條理****。

****whip into shape**** is stronger and more informal.

28. shape up

A. improve your behavior or performance

****振作；改善表現****

1. You need to ****shape up**** if you want to keep the job.

如果你想保住工作，就得****改善表現****。

B. develop or progress in a particular way

****發展成；呈現出.....趨勢****

2. The project is ****shaping up well****.

這個專案目前****進展得很好****。

Useful phrasal verb.

29. shape up to be something

= develop in such a way that something is likely to become true

****逐漸呈現出會成為.....的樣子****

Examples

1. It's ****shaping up to be a busy week****.
這週看來****會變得很忙****。
2. The event is ****shaping up to be a success****.
這場活動看來****正逐漸朝成功發展****。

30. shape up or ship out

= improve your behavior/performance or leave

****不改善就走人****

Examples

1. The manager basically told them to ****shape up or ship out****.
經理基本上就是告訴他們：****要嘛改善表現，要嘛走人****。
2. It's a harsh **“**shape up or ship out**”** culture.
那是一種很強硬的「****不進步就走人****」文化。

Informal and forceful.

Related forms

31. shaped

= having a particular form

****.....形的；具有.....形狀的****

Examples

1. The room is L-****shaped****.
房間是 ****L 形的****。
2. She wore a heart-****shaped**** necklace.
她戴著一條****心形****項鍊。

Common compounds:

- * heart-shaped
- * star-shaped
- * U-shaped
- * pear-shaped

32. shapeless

= lacking a clear or attractive shape

****沒有明確形狀的；鬆垮無形的****

Examples

1. The old sweater had become ****shapeless****.
那件舊毛衣已經變得****鬆垮走樣****。

2. A ****shapeless mass**** lay on the floor.
地上有一團****沒有明確形狀的東西****。

33. shapely

= having an attractive, well-proportioned shape, especially of the body or legs

****線條優美的；身材勻稱的****

Examples

1. The sculpture has a ****shapely form****.
那座雕塑有****優美的線條****。

2. The word ****shapely**** is sometimes used to describe an attractive figure.
****shapely**** 有時用來形容****勻稱好看的身材****。

Can sound somewhat old-fashioned when describing people.

34. reshape

= shape again or change the form, structure, or direction of something

****重新塑造；重塑****

Examples

1. Technology is **reshaping** the workplace.

科技正在**重塑**職場。

2. The experience **reshaped** her priorities.

那次經歷**重新塑造**了她的優先順序。

Very useful figurative derivative.

35. reshaping

= process of changing form, structure, or development

重塑；**重新塑造**

Examples

1. The industry is undergoing major **reshaping**.

這個產業正經歷重大**重塑**。

2. Social change is **reshaping** family life.

社會變遷正在**重塑**家庭生活。

Key contrasts

36. shape vs form

Both can mean **形狀 / 形式**, but:

shape

often emphasizes external outline or configuration.

form

is broader and can refer to:

* physical structure

* arrangement

* type

* manner

Compare:

> The object has an unusual **shape**.

> 這個物體的**外形**很特別。

> The substance changed **form**.

> 這種物質改變了**形態**。

37. shape vs size

shape

= form or outline

形狀

size

= how large or small something is

大小

Two objects can have:

- * the same shape

- * different sizes

38. shape vs figure

shape

= general outline or form

figure

can mean:

- * body shape

- * person seen at a distance

- * number

- * diagram

Compare:

> a strange **shape** in the darkness

> 黑暗中的奇怪輪廓

> a dark **figure** standing by the door

> 站在門邊的黑色人影

39. shape vs mold

As verbs:

****shape****

= influence or form gradually

****塑造****

****mold****

= shape strongly, often according to a particular pattern or model

****塑造 ; 使定型****

Compare:

> Experiences ****shape**** personality.

> 經歷會****塑造****性格。

> Strict training ****molded**** him into a disciplined athlete.

> 嚴格訓練把他****塑造成****自律的運動員。

****Mold**** can sound stronger and more controlling.

40. shape vs influence

****influence****

= affect someone or something

****影響****

****shape****

= influence development in a way that helps determine its eventual form

****塑造****

Compare:

> Her teacher ****influenced**** her.

> 老師****影響了****她。

> Her teacher ****shaped the way she thought****.

> 老師****塑造了****她的思考方式******。

****Shape**** usually suggests a deeper or more formative effect.

41. shape vs determine

****shape****

= influence strongly but not necessarily completely

****determine****

= decide, control, or establish an outcome more definitively

****決定****

Compare:

> Childhood experiences ****shape**** personality.

> 童年經歷會****塑造****性格。

This does not necessarily mean they completely ****determine**** personality.

That distinction matters in careful writing.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****shape**** is:

****form or outline****

From this develop several branches:

Physical form

shape of an object

→ ****形狀****

Human body

body shape

→ ****體形****

General condition

in good shape

→ ****狀況良好****

Physical formation

shape clay

→ **塑形**

Personal development

shape character

→ **塑造性格**

Thinking and worldview

shape the way someone sees something

→ **塑造看法**

Future development

shape the future / outcome

→ **影響走向**

Emerging structure

take shape

→ **逐漸成形**

The metaphor is very natural:

give a physical object a form

→ **give ideas, character, or events their developing form**

Passage recap

> “Her influence has been long-lasting because it **shaped the way I see learning, confidence, and even character**.”

Here:

shape = **strongly influence how a person’s ideas, attitudes, or character develop**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **塑造**

* **形成**

* **深刻影響.....的形成**

* contextually: **她塑造了我看待學習、自信，甚至品格的方式**

MCQ-ready meaning

shape in the passage

= **influence and help determine how something develops**

塑造；影響.....的形成與發展

It does not refer to physical **形狀** here, although the figurative meaning comes directly from the image of **giving something its form**.